

FRANCISCO PABLO FLORES TAIPE

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School of Social Science - University of Iceland
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RESEARCH INTERESTS

Research Interests: economics of education, social inequality, educational transitions, gender economics, (behavioral) development economics.

ACADEMIC POSITIONS

Postdoc in the EDUCHANGE project University of Iceland (Iceland)	<i>Sep. 2025</i>
Postdoc in the Chair of Methods of Empirical Social Research Universität Potsdam (Germany)	<i>Sep. 2024 - Aug. 2025</i>
Postdoc in the Economics of Innovation and Creativity Chair Leibniz Universität Hannover (LUH) (Germany)	<i>Aug. 2023 - Aug. 2025</i>

EDUCATION

Doctor in Economics (summa cum laude) University of Kassel (Germany) Thesis: Testing the Impact of Large-scale Digital Support on Students' Paths Toward College Education.	<i>2018 - 2023</i>
M.Sc. in Economic Behavior and Governance University of Kassel (Germany) Thesis: Showing Life Opportunities: Increasing opportunity-driven entrepreneurship and STEM careers through online courses in schools.	<i>2016 - 2018</i>
B.Sc. in Economics Pontificia Universidad Católica del Ecuador (Ecuador) Thesis: The Ecuadorian electricity sector over the last 20 years: strategies to achieve energy security.	<i>2005 - 2011</i>

PUBLICATIONS

Asanov, Igor; Astebro, Thomas; Buenstorf, Guido; Crepón, Bruno; Flores Taipe, Francisco; McKenzie, David; Mensmann, Mona; and Schulte, Mathis. (2026) "Remote delivery of STEM and entrepreneurship role models at scale changes college major choice in Ecuador."

Nature Human Behaviour, 2026

Asanov, Igor; Asanov (Noha), Anastasiya; Astebro, Thomas; Buenstorf, Guido; Crepón, Bruno; Flores Taipe, Francisco; McKenzie, David; Mensmann, Mona; and Schulte, Mathis. (2023) "System-, Teacher-, and Student-level Interventions for Improving Participation in Online Learning at Scale in High Schools."

PNAS, 120 (30)

Asanov, Igor; Flores Taipe, Francisco; McKenzie, David; Mensmann, Mona, and Schulte, Mathis. (2021) "Remote-learning, time-use, and mental health of Ecuadorian high-school students during the COVID-19 quarantine." **World Development, Vol. 138.**

WORKING PAPERS

Flores Taipe, Francisco. "Academic aspirations and income inequality: spillover effects of a video-based role model intervention among teenagers." **(single-author paper)**

Flores Taipe, Francisco; and Reimer, David. "Role Models and Human-Capital Choices: Evidence on Enrollment and Major Selection" **(Chapter at the Handbook of Labor, Human Resources, and Population Economics. Editor: Prof. Klaus F. Zimmermann)**

WORK IN PROGRESS

Flores Taipe, Francisco; and Reimer, David. "Who Accepts Counseling? Determinants of Take-Up Among First-Generation Students and Implications for Access to Higher Education." **(pre-registration)**

Kohlmeier, Markus; Reimer, David; and Flores Taipe, Francisco. "Can a Role Model Intervention Decrease Inequality in Access to Higher Education? Results from a Comparative Randomized Controlled Trial in Denmark, Germany, Hungary, and Iceland" **(pre-registration)**

Asanov, Igor; Astebro, Thomas; Buenstorf, Guido; Crepón, Bruno; Flores Taipe, Francisco; McKenzie, David; Mensmann, Mona; and Schulte, Mathis. "Online Soft- and Hard-Skills Training at Scale in High-schools" **(pre-registration)**

Flores Taipe, Francisco. "Academic Aspirations and Gender Homophily: The Causal Effect of Male and Female Role Models on Ecuadorian High School Students."

TEACHING ACTIVITIES

Lecturer: in chronological order

- Economics of Entrepreneurship *Winter Semester 2024 - 2025 — 5 ECTS*

- Behavioral Economics of Poverty *Summer Semester 2024 — 5 ECTS*

- Economics of Entrepreneurship *Winter Semester 2023 - 2024 — 5 ECTS*

- Behavioral Economics of Poverty *Summer Semester 2023 — 5 ECTS*

- Economics of Entrepreneurship *Summer Semester 2021 — 6 ECTS*

Adjunct Lecturer: in chronological order

- Education, Social Mobility and Social Stratification *Fall 2026 — 5 ECTS*

- Survey Research Methods *Spring 2026 — 5 ECTS*

- (Quasi-) Experiments in Entrepreneurship Research *Winter Semester 2019 - 2020 — 6 ECTS*

- Field Experiments *Summer Semester 2019 — 3 ECTS*

- Intellectual Property Rights *Winter Semester 2018 - 2019 — 6 ECTS*

Member of doctoral board:

- Püttmann, V. (2024) Doctoral thesis: Essays on the Interrelations Between Academics and Society

Thesis Supervisor:

- Thies, A. E. (2022 — 30 ECTS) MSc thesis: Greenspace and adolescents' mental health: literature review and suggestions for future research

- Zeyrek, M. (2022 — 30 ECTS) MSc thesis: The Effect of Labor Market Conditions on Gender-Based Violence: A Literature Review

SKILLS

Computer R, STATA, Qualtrics
Languages Spanish (native), English (fluent), German (TELC-certified B1)

PROJECTS

Changing Inequality at Educational Transitions (EDUCHANGE)

ERC Consolidator Grant

Role: Postdoctoral researcher (2025-2027)

Showing Life Opportunities (SLO)

World Bank Strategic Impact Evaluation Fund, Innovation Growth Lab, Innovations for Poverty Action, Labex ECODEC ENSAE; University of Kassel

Role: Doctoral student (2018-2023)

JOURNAL MANUSCRIPT REVIEWER

Ad-hoc Reviewer: Education Economics — Journal

HONOURS AND AWARDS

Path to Scale Award (2019)

Donor: Innovation for Poverty Action (IPA)

Project: Showing Life Opportunities: Increasing opportunity-driven entrepreneurship and STEM careers through online courses in schools.

Path to Scale Grant (2020)

Donor: Innovation for Poverty Action (IPA)

Project: The Impact of an Online Entrepreneurial Mindset Training for Youth in Ecuador.

IGL Grants Program (2018)

Donor: Innovation Growth Lab (IGL)

Project: Showing Life Opportunities: Increasing opportunity-driven entrepreneurship and STEM careers through online courses in schools.

NETWORKS AND MEMBERSHIPS

Innovation for Poverty Action (IPA)

Since 2020

International Center for Higher Education Research (INCHER)

Since 2019

Economics Science Association (ESA)

Since 2018

SELECTED CONFERENCES AND WORKSHOPS

Flores, F. "EDUCHANGE: Changing Inequality at Educational Transitions", I Workshop: Reimagining policy experimentation in Europe. June 24th to 25th, Brussels (Belgium).

Flores, F. "Can a Role Model Intervention Decrease Inequality in Access to Higher Education? Results from a Comparative Randomized Controlled Trial in Denmark, Germany, Hungary, and Iceland", ACES 2025. August 27th to 28th, Leipzig (Germany).

Flores, F. "Academic aspirations and income inequality: spillover effects of a video-based role model intervention among teenagers." SEET 2023. February 2nd, Valencia (Spain).

Flores, F. "Inspiring the way to a better future: The effect of role models on reshaping the academic ambitions of disadvantaged students." ESA's Job-Market Candidates Seminar Series. December 14th (online).

Flores, F. "Inspiring the way to a better future: The effect of role models on reshaping the academic ambitions of disadvantaged students." AEFPP workshop: Junior Scholars and the Job Market. November 11th (online).

Flores, F.: Aspirations, Poverty and Education: Can a role model intervention mitigate the consequences of deprivation? Lessons from Ecuador. ESA European Meeting. September 3rd, Bologna (Italy).

Flores, F.: Effects of a Role Models Intervention on Promoting STEM and Entrepreneurship Activities among High School Students. Experimental Economics Conference 2022 (USFQ). July 7th, Galapagos (Ecuador). (Co-authors: Asanov I., Astebro T., Bünstorf G., Crépon B., McKenzie D., Mensmann M., Schulte M.)

Flores, F.: Effects of a Role Models Intervention on Promoting STEM and Entrepreneurship Activities among High School Students. ESA World Meeting. June 15th, Boston (USA). (Co-authors: Asanov I., Astebro T., Bünstorf G., Crépon B., McKenzie D., Mensmann M., Schulte M.)

Flores, F.: Effects of a Role Models Intervention on Promoting STEM and Entrepreneurship Activities among High School Students. Advance in Field Experiments Meeting (AFE). June 9th, Chicago (USA). (Co-authors: Asanov I., Astebro T., Bünstorf G., Crépon B., McKenzie D., Mensmann M., Schulte M.)

Flores, F.: Effects of a Role Models Intervention on Promoting STEM and Entrepreneurship Activities among High School Students. Copenhagen Education Network Workshop (CEN). March 29th, Copenhagen (Denmark). (Coauthors: Asanov I., Astebro T., Bünstorf G., Crépon B., McKenzie D., Mensmann M., Schulte M.)

Flores, F.: Impacts of Personal Initiative and Negotiations Training on Remote-Learning, Time-Use, and Mental Health of Ecuadorian High-School Students during the COVID-19 Quarantine. ESA World Meeting. September 11th, Virtual. (Co-authors: Asanov I., McKenzie D., Mensmann M., Schulte M.)

ESA = Economic Science Association — SEET = Southern Europe Experimental Team

AEFP = Association For Education Finance and Policy

LESE = Lisbon Economics and Statistics of Education

SEEDEC = Symposium on Economic Experiments in Developing Countries

ACES = Annual Conference of Experimental Sociology

WORK EXPERIENCE

The World Bank Group

May 2023 - May. 2023

Short-term Consultant

- Designing an assessment tool to measure adolescents' perceptions of educational videos.
- Validating the assessment tool with qualitative evidence (focus groups).
- Collecting young adults' perceptions of a set of videos featuring role models.

The World Bank Group

July 2020 - Oct. 2020

Short-term Consultant

- Monitoring rapid-fire data collection using phone-based tools.
- Organizing data collection during the COVID-19 health emergency.
- Setting the field to expand an online educational program nationwide.
- Monitoring a team that supports students and teachers while interacting with online solutions.
- Solving issues associated with working with new technologies, particularly in remote areas.

The World Bank Group

May 2019 - Aug. 2019

Short-term Consultant

- Piloting an online intervention designed to train high school students at scale.
- Training teachers and administrative personnel to work with online solutions at scale.

University of Kassel

Feb. 2017 - Apr. 2018

Research Assistant

- Research fields: record linkages, the economics of innovation.
- Key tasks: literature review, data cleaning, compilation, and preparation.

Quantitative Research Center for Economic and Social Development (Económica-CIC)

Apr. 2014 - Apr. 2015

Senior consultant

- Evaluation of educative solutions to improve students' situation at scale (mixed methods).
- Preparing policy briefs to document lessons learned of project interventions.
- Presenting research findings to policymakers and the general audience.
- Supporting dialogue with policymakers from organizations such as the Ministry of Education of Ecuador or the National Secretary of Planning (Senplades).

Ekos corporation

Apr. 2010 - Nov. 2013

Regional Coordinator of Economic Content

- Design and monitoring of indexes for measuring private and public companies' performance.
- Managing human and financial resources.
- Drafting articles and special editions for the Ekos Magazine for Ecuador and Peru.

REFERENCES

Guido Bünstorf

Professor
at the Department of Economics
at the University of Kassel (PhD Supervisor)
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David Reimer

Professor of Sociology of Education
at the School of Education and the School of Social Sciences
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